



The way Cloudmark works

Most browsers are becoming quick to the phishing threat. The new Internet Explorer (Microsoft IE 7) browser and the to-be-released Firefox 2 (codenamed Bon Echo) have both installed anti-phishing features. Essentially, both browsers check the URL against a list of known phishing sites, and block or unblock content on that basis.

6.3.2 Pharming

Like phishing, pharming is another attempt by hackers to divulge personal information from you, and eventually, your money.

Pharming is basically the process of redirecting your browser from the site you originally wanted to visit to a malicious one. But the way you get caught in the pharmer's scams is because the sites are designed to look like the ones you originally wanted to visit. In this way they deceive you, bring you to their sites, and make you divulge information.

For example, the pharmer could divert your browser from the original Gmail Web site, to a look-alike and then save your username and password. This is a very simple example; there are much further lengths that pharmer's will go to get your private information. The advantage that pharmer's have over phishers is